

Environment Variables

Use environment variables to manage configuration values for your Storefront Next storefront without making code changes. They're stored securely outside your codebase, making them ideal for API keys for third-party integrations, feature flags for application logic, and configuration that differs between environments such as development, staging, and production. Environment variables are accessible in your app server code only and aren't available to edge services.

Prerequisites

You must have a developer or admin role on the project for which you're managing environment variables. If you don't have access, ask a Managed Runtime admin for access.

Environment Variable Types

Storefront Next uses a naming convention to control where a variable is available.

- **PUBLIC__** prefix: Variables with this prefix are safe to expose to the browser. They're automatically merged into the app configuration at run time and available in both server and client code via `getConfig()` and `useConfig()`. Use these for client IDs, feature flags, public API endpoints, and other non-sensitive values.
- No prefix: Variables without the **PUBLIC__** prefix are server-only. They're never bundled into client JavaScript. Use these for secrets, API credentials, and private tokens. Read them directly from `process.env` in server-side code such as loaders, actions, and middleware.

The PUBLIC__ Path Syntax

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For example, this environment variable:

```
1 PUBLIC__app__myFeature__apiEndpoint=https:
```

Maps to this config path:

```
1 config.app.myFeature.apiEndpoint
```

Values are automatically parsed to the correct type:

```
1 PUBLIC__app__myFeature__count=42 # → number
2 PUBLIC__app__myFeature__enabled=true # → boolean
3 PUBLIC__app__myFeature__items=["a","b"] # → array
4 PUBLIC__app__myFeature__data={"x":1} # → object
5 PUBLIC__app__myFeature__name=hello # → string
```

For complex nested values, set an entire object at once using JSON:

```
1 PUBLIC__app__pages__cart={"quantityUpdate
```

When you set environment variables in Runtime Admin, use single-line JSON without surrounding quotes.

Manage Environment Variables in Runtime Admin

Manage environment variables in the UI in Runtime Admin.

Use Runtime Admin

To create, update, remove, or view environment variables:

1. If you created your storefront in Business Manager, access your environment variables from the storefront page.
 - a. In Business Manager, click App Launcher  and then select **Administration > Sites > Storefronts**, and then click your storefront.
 - b. In the storefront detail page, click the environment, and then click **Manage** next to **Environment Variables**. You're redirected to the



- a. Log in to [Runtime Admin](#).
- b. Go to a project's Overview page.
- c. Click the name of the environment.
- d. Click **Environment Variables** in the left navigation.

When you add a new environment variable, wait for the redeploy of the bundle to complete, and then deploy a new bundle that uses the new variable.

**Note**

Also, you can manage environment variables via the CLI or API. See [Automate Environment Variable Management with the CLI or API](#).

Best Practices

- Choose clear, descriptive names for your environment variables.
- Avoid hardcoding sensitive information such as API keys in your code. Use environment variables to keep them secure.
- Don't pass environment variables into data that will be serialized to the page. Consider adding a test to make sure you're not leaking environment variable data.
- Never store secrets or private keys in `PUBLIC__` variables. They're exposed to the browser.
- Read server-only secrets directly from `process.env`. Never pass them through the config system.
- Test variable changes locally and in a non-production environment before applying them to production. Testing in stages helps resolve issues early, simulate site behavior, validate functionality, and run user acceptance testing before deploying to production.
- Add error handling in your code for cases where a variable might be undefined.
- Don't return environment variables from `loader` functions or react-query hooks.
- Use environment variables only server-side. By default, environment variables aren't exposed client-side. To expose them client-side (for example, in your configuration file), make sure that exposing the values complies with your security practices.
- Control access to the environment variables to prevent unauthorized modifications.



- Restart your dev server after changing `.env` files. Environment variables load at startup.

Constraints

Environment variables are subject to these constraints.

- Each environment has a limit of 100 environment variables.
- Environment variable names can contain only alphanumeric characters, underscores (`_`), and dashes (`-`).
- Environment variable names must be 512 characters or less, and cannot start with reserved prefixes: `AWS` , `MRT` , `X_MRT` , `MOBIFY` , `X_MOBIFY` , `SSR_PROXY` , `NODE` .
- Environment variable names cannot use any reserved names: `BUNDLE_ID` , `DEPLOY_ID` , `DEPLOY_TARGET` , `EXTERNAL_DOMAIN_NAME` , `HANDLER` , `LAMBDA_RUNTIME_DIR` , `LAMBDA_TASK_ROOT` , `NODE_ENV` , `REDIRECT_BUCKET` , `REDIRECT_KEY` , `REDIRECT_UPDATE` , `REMOTE` , `X_AMZN_TRACE_ID` .
- Environment variable values must be strings. To store complex values, encode JSON into a string.
- The maximum size of the values of environment variables set for an environment is 32 KB.
- Paths used in `PUBLIC__` variable names must already exist in `config.server.ts` . Variables that reference undefined paths are rejected at startup.

See Also

- [Troubleshoot Environment Variables](#)
- [Managed Runtime Overview](#)

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